

# Your Stress Test

## Why this test?

Stress testing assesses your heart during exercise or medication-induced stress. It may help evaluate symptoms, blood flow or exercise capacity.

## How to prepare

Ask which type of test you are having. Follow the center's instructions about food, caffeine and medicines. Do not hold a prescribed medicine unless the testing team tells you to.

## What to expect

Staff monitor your symptoms, ECG, heart rate and BP. Some tests add ultrasound or nuclear imaging. Tell the team about breathing problems, medication reactions, pregnancy possibility or difficulty walking.

## What happens next?

A normal test is reassuring for the question tested, but does not exclude all plaque or every cause of symptoms. An abnormal or inconclusive result may lead to treatment changes or more testing.

## Questions to bring

- Which type of stress test am I having, and why?
- What exact preparation and medication instructions should I follow?
- Does the result change my activity or treatment?

My next step / follow-up: \_\_\_\_\_

**Urgent symptoms:** Call 911 for severe chest symptoms, fainting, stroke symptoms or severe trouble breathing. Do not wait for a scheduled test or its report.

Full guide and references: <https://bmorecardiology.com/tests/stress-test.html>

Source: [AHA: Exercise Stress Test \(2025\)](#)

Source: [AHA: Myocardial Perfusion Imaging - PET and SPECT \(2025\)](#)

Independent educational resource. Use your own clinician's instructions.